

REPORTED SPEECH PRACTICE

Choose between said / told

Rule reminder:

✓ **said** → se usa cuando no se menciona a quién se habla

✓ **told** → siempre va seguido de la persona a quien se le dice algo (me, him, her, us, them, Tom, etc.)

1. He: "I am hungry."
→ He _____ that he was hungry.
2. Anna: "I will wait for you at the station."
→ Anna _____ me that she would wait for me at the station.
3. They: "We can't come today."
→ They _____ that they couldn't come that day.
4. The teacher: "The homework is for tomorrow."
→ The teacher _____ us that the homework was for the next day.
5. My brother: "I am going to buy some bread."
→ My brother _____ that he was going to buy some bread.
6. Lucy: "I have already finished my work."
→ Lucy _____ that she had already finished her work.
7. The police officer: "Show me your ID."
→ The police officer _____ him to show his ID.
8. My parents: "We will go on a trip in August."
→ My parents _____ that they would go on a trip in August.
9. Carlos: "I don't know where the key is."
→ Carlos _____ me that he didn't know where the key was.
10. The nurse: "You must rest."
→ The nurse _____ her that she had to rest.
11. I: "I will arrive early."
→ I _____ that I would arrive early.

12. Martha: "I watched a very good movie yesterday."
→ Martha _____ us that she had watched a very good movie the day before.
13. The guide: "The museum opens at 9:00."
→ The guide _____ that the museum opened at 9:00.
14. Luis: "I don't like coffee."
→ Luis _____ me that he didn't like coffee.
15. They: "We were studying when you called."
→ They _____ that they had been studying when I called.
16. The doctor: "You have to take this medicine."
→ The doctor _____ him that he had to take that medicine.
17. My friend: "I lived in Madrid two years ago."
→ My friend _____ that she had lived in Madrid two years before.
18. The boss: "Finish the report before Friday."
→ The boss _____ us to finish the report before Friday.
19. Peter: "I can't attend the meeting."
→ Peter _____ that he couldn't attend the meeting.
20. The shop assistant: "These shoes cost 500 pesos."
→ The shop assistant _____ me that those shoes cost 500 pesos.
21. We: "We haven't received the package."
→ We _____ that we hadn't received the package.
22. Sofia: "I will go visit my grandmother this weekend."
→ Sofia _____ her mother that she would go visit her grandmother that weekend.
23. The coach: "Do exercise every day."
→ The coach _____ us to do exercise every day.
24. John: "I met your cousin at university."
→ John _____ that he had met my cousin at university.
25. The neighbor: "My dog ran away yesterday."
→ The neighbor _____ me that her dog had run away the day before.
26. The children: "We want to play in the park."

- The children _____ that they wanted to play in the park.
27. The advisor: "You must check the documents carefully."
→ The advisor _____ me that I had to check the documents carefully.
28. Mark: "I will call you later."
→ Mark _____ that he would call me later.
29. She: "I didn't see anyone there."
→ She _____ me that she hadn't seen anyone there.
30. The manager: "The store closes at 8:00 PM."
→ The manager _____ that the store closed at 8:00 PM.

REPORTED SPEECH EXERCISES

Instructions:

Rewrite the direct speech into reported speech. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb and, where indicated, choose between **said** or **told**.

- Use only: Present Simple → Past Simple / Present Continuous → Past Continuous
- Sentences can be affirmative or negative

◆ Part 1: Present Simple → Past Simple (Exercises 1–15)

- Direct: "I **work** in a hospital."
Reported: He _____ that he _____ in a hospital.
- Direct: "We **do not watch** TV late."
Reported: They _____ me that they _____ TV late.
- Direct: "She **plays** the piano very well."
Reported: He _____ that she _____ the piano very well.
- Direct: "I **do not like** spicy food."
Reported: She _____ us that she _____ spicy food.
- Direct: "You **speak** excellent Spanish."
Reported: He _____ that I _____ отличный Spanish.
- Direct: "They **travel** by train every year."
Reported: She _____ that they _____ by train every year.
- Direct: "He **does not study** chemistry."

- Reported: They _____ her that he _____ chemistry.
8. Direct: "It **rains** a lot here in summer."
Reported: He _____ that it _____ a lot here in summer.
9. Direct: "We **need** more practice."
Reported: She _____ me that they _____ more practice.
10. Direct: "I **do not have** enough time."
Reported: He _____ that he _____ enough time.
11. Direct: "The shop **opens** at 8:00 AM."
Reported: They _____ us that the shop _____ at 8:00 AM.
12. Direct: "You **do not know** the answer."
Reported: She _____ that I _____ the answer.
13. Direct: "My father **fixes** computers."
Reported: He _____ me that his father _____ computers.
14. Direct: "We **do not eat** fish."
Reported: They _____ that they _____ fish.
15. Direct: "She **knows** all the teachers."
Reported: He _____ her that she _____ all the teachers.
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◆ Part 2 *, Present Continuous → Past Continuous (Exercises 16–30)

16. Direct: "I **am reading** a science book."
Reported: He _____ that he _____ a science book.
17. Direct: "They **are not watching** the match."
Reported: She _____ us that they _____ the match.
18. Direct: "She **is cooking** lunch."
Reported: He _____ that she _____ lunch.
19. Direct: "We **are waiting** for the bus."
Reported: They _____ me that they _____ for the bus.
20. Direct: "I **am not wearing** my jacket."
Reported: She _____ that she _____ her jacket.
21. Direct: "You **are doing** a good job."
Reported: He _____ me that I _____ a good job.
22. Direct: "He **is not working** this week."
Reported: They _____ her that he _____ this week.
23. Direct: "It **is snowing** in the mountains."
Reported: He _____ that it _____ in the mountains.
24. Direct: "We **are planning** a party."

- Reported: She _____ us that they _____ a party.
25. Direct: "The children **are playing** outside."
- Reported: He _____ that the children _____ outside.
26. Direct: "I **am not listening** to music."
- Reported: They _____ me that he _____ to music.
27. Direct: "She **is learning** English."
- Reported: He _____ that she _____ English.
28. Direct: "They **are not traveling** this month."
- Reported: She _____ us that they _____ this month.
29. Direct: "You **are making** a mistake."
- Reported: He _____ that I _____ a mistake.
30. Direct: "We **are painting** the bedroom."
- Reported: They _____ her that they _____ the bedroom.
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◆ Part 3: Mixed Practice (Random order, Exercises 31–60)

*→ In **10 exercises marked with ☆**, you must choose between **said** or **told** to complete the sentence correctly.*

31. Direct: "I **am writing** a letter."
- Reported: She _____ that she _____ a letter.
- ☆ 32. Direct: "We **do not go** out at night."
- Reported: He _____ me that they _____ out at night.
33. Direct: "They **are building** a new school."
- Reported: He _____ that they _____ a new school.
- ☆ 34. Direct: "She **teaches** history at the college."
- Reported: They _____ us that she _____ history at the college.
35. Direct: "I **am not feeling** very well."
- Reported: She _____ that she _____ very well.
- ☆ 36. Direct: "You **live** in a quiet neighborhood."
- Reported: He _____ me that I _____ in a quiet neighborhood.
37. Direct: "It **is getting** colder."
- Reported: She _____ that it _____ colder.
- ☆ 38. Direct: "He **does not help** with the housework."
- Reported: They _____ her that he _____ with the housework.
39. Direct: "We **are visiting** some friends."
- Reported: He _____ that they _____ some friends.

☆ 40. Direct: "The moon **goes** around the Earth."

Reported: She _____ us that the moon _____ around the Earth.

41. Direct: "I **am not using** my laptop."

Reported: He _____ that he _____ his laptop.

☆ 42. Direct: "They **sell** fresh bread every morning."

Reported: She _____ me that they _____ fresh bread every morning.

43. Direct: "She **is trying** to fix the computer."

Reported: He _____ that she _____ to fix the computer.

☆ 44. Direct: "We **do not agree** with that idea."

Reported: They _____ him that they _____ with that idea.

45 Interview. Direct: "You **are speaking** too loudly."

Reported: She _____ that I _____ too loudly.

☆ 46. Direct: "He **works** in the city center."

Reported: He _____ her that he _____ in the city center.

47. Direct: "I **am having** dinner now."

Reported: She _____ that she _____ dinner.

☆ 48. Direct: "They **do not understand** the instructions."

Reported: He _____ us that they _____ metaφopy the instructions.

49. Direct: "It **is changing** very fast."

Reported: They _____ that it _____ very fast.

50. Direct: "She **writes** articles for a magazine."

Reported: He _____ that she _____ articles for a magazine.

51. Direct: "We **are not staying** here long."

Reported: She _____ that they _____ here long.

52. Direct: "You **need** a new pair of shoes."

Reported: He _____ me that I _____ a new pair of shoes.

53. Direct: "I **am studying** French."

Reported: He _____ that he _____ French.

54. Direct: "He **does not drink** coffee."

Reported: She _____ us that he _____ coffee.

55. Direct: "They **are traveling** to Canada."

Reported: They _____ that they _____ to Canada.

56. Direct: "The meeting **starts** at 9:30 AM."

Reported: He _____ her that the meeting _____ at 9:30 AM.

57. Direct: "I **am not planning** anything for today."

Reported: She _____ that she _____ anything for today.

58. Direct: "She **speaks** Italian and German."

Reported: He _____ me that she _____ Italian and German.

59. Direct: "We **are preparing** the presentation."

Reported: They _____ that they _____ the presentation.

60. Direct: "You **do not remember** our conversation."

Reported: She _____ him that I _____ our conversation.